County of San Diego, Health and Human Services Agency
CalWORKs Program Guide Special Notice

Increase to Maximum Aid Payment – October 2026	**Number**	**Page**
	26-04	1 of 1

Effective Date:
October 1, 2026

Background:
The state establishes the Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) levels, which are used to determine CalWORKs grant amounts.

Purpose:
The purpose of this special notice is to inform staff of a 1.8% MAP increase, and Income Reporting Threshold (IRT) levels increase. The increases take effect October 1, 2026.

Policy:
MAP level changes require county-initiated mid-period action for all CalWORKs cases.

Procedure:
- Customers are required to be notified of the MAP increase and associated impact to their CalFresh benefits by September 20, 2026, to meet (10-day) timely noticing regulations.
- All CalWORKs customers have been issued the State Law Changes the Maximum Aid Payment Levels for Cash Aid Recipients (TEMP 2250) via mass mailing.
- Staff are to provide the TEMP 2250 to all customers who apply for CalWORKs in August through October 2026, and document in a journal entry that the notice was provided and explained.
- The Grant Increase/Law Change (TM44-315P) Notice of Action (NOA) is to be used to notify customers when their grant will increase due to the MAP change.

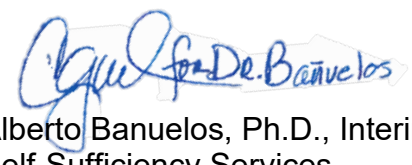
Impacts:
The increase in CalWORKs MAP may cause a decrease in CalFresh benefits. Staff must review the impacted case and take action as needed. Updates to the CalSAWS reference tables, to reflect the new MAP and IRT levels, took place on September 10, 2026.

Scratch Budget/Assistance Charts
The CalWORKs-CalFresh Scratch Budget has been updated with the new MAP and IRT levels for October 2026. The CalWORKs Assistance Standards Chart and the CalWORKs Maximum Aid Payment Chart have been updated with the new MAP and IRT levels.

References:
California State Budget Federal Fiscal Year (FFY) 2026-2027, All County Letter 26-62.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by October 31, 2027.

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services

CalWORKs Assistance Standards

Minimum Basic Standard of Adequate Care (MBSAC) and Income In-Kind (IIK) (07/26)

AU	MBSAC	Housing	Utilities	Food	Clothing
1	$963	$437	$92	$239	$73
2	$1,581	$580	$106	$511	$142
3	$1,960	$635	$109	$655	$211
4	$2,325	$668	$115	$809	$282
5	$2,653	$668	$115	$981	$358
6	$2,983	$668	$115	$1,134	$430
7	$3,280	$668	$115	$1,265	$501
8	$3,569	$668	$115	$1,380	$557
9	$3,872	$668	$115	$1,519	$640
10*	$4,202	$668	$115	$1,643	$701

*More than 10 add $37 to MBSAC for each additional person

Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) (10/26)

AU	Exempt	Non-Exempt
1	$824	$747
2	$1,058	$947
3	$1,338	$1,196
4	$1,607	$1,441
5	$1,883	$1,689
6	$2,161	$1,936
7	$2,438	$2,184
8	$2,717	$2,432
9	$2,992	$2,678
10+	$3,273	$2,928

EXEMPT AU: An AU is considered exempt when each adult parent/caretaker relative meets one of the following criteria:

- Is an unaided non-parent caretaker relative
- Is disabled and receiving one of the following:
  - Supplemental Security Income/State Supplemental Payments (SSI/SSP)
  - In-Home Supportive Services (IHSS)
  - State Disability Insurance (SDI)
  - Temporary Worker's Compensation (TWC)
  - Temporary Disability Indemnity (TDI)

Income Reporting Threshold (IRT) (10/26)

CalWORKs IRT is the lesser of Tier 1 or Tier 2:

Tier 1: **$1,252*** plus the gross income last used in the CalWORKs benefit determination.

*Amount is provided by CDSS (55% of the FPL for a family of three, regardless of actual AU size)

Tier 2: 130% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL)

AU	IRT
0	$1,729
1	$1,729
2	$2,345
3	$2,960
4	$3,575
5	$4,191
6	$4,806
7	$5,421
8	$6,037
Each additional member	$616

Child Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) Chart Effective October 1, 2026

Single Child Participating in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option

Assistance Unit (AU) Size	Region 1 Exempt	Region 1 Non-Exempt
2 For a child in this AU size to participate, the adult(s) cannot be aided. The remaining AU members must be a CalWORKs eligible step or half-sibling.	$234 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$434 Child MAP	$200 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$400 Child MAP
3	$280 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$480 Child MAP	$249 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$449 Child MAP
4	$269 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$469 Child MAP	$245 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$445 Child MAP
5	$276 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$476 Child MAP	$248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$448 Child MAP
6	$278 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$478 Child MAP	$247 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$447 Child MAP
7	$277 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$477 Child MAP	$248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$448 Child MAP
8	$279 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$479 Child MAP	$248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$448 Child MAP
9	$275 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$475 Child MAP	$246 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$446 Child MAP
10	$281 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$481 Child MAP	$250 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard =$450 Child MAP

Counties shall use the figures noted as “Child MAP” to determine if the amount of child support is greater than the amount the child would receive for CalWORKs (Please note for simplicity, income would not be a factor and a straight MAP would be used).

If the amount of child support received is greater than the “Child MAP” for the child’s AU size with the child included, region and AU type, the child is able to participate in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant if all other conditions are met.

Child Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) Chart Effective October 1, 2026

Multiple Children Participating in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option

Multi-child opt-in to Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option is not available for an Assistance Unit (AU) size of two. At least one CalWORKs aided child must be in the AU

Assistance Unit Size	Region 1 Exempt	Region 1 Non-Exempt
3 For a child in this AU size to participate, the adult(s) cannot be aided. The remaining AU member must be a CalWORKs eligible step or half-sibling.	Child 1 $280 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $480 Child MAP Child 2 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $249 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $449 Child MAP Child 2 $200 Child MAP
4 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of two children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $269 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $469 Child MAP Child 2 $280 Child MAP Child 3 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $245 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $445 Child MAP Child 2 $249 Child MAP Child 3 $200 Child MAP
5 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of three children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $276 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $476 Child MAP Child 2 $269 Child MAP Child 3 $280 Child MAP Child 4 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $448 Child MAP Child 2 $245 Child MAP Child 3 $249 Child MAP Child 4 $200 Child MAP
6 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of four children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $278 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $478 Child MAP Child 2 $276 Child MAP Child 3 $269 Child MAP Child 4 $280 Child MAP Child 5 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $247 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $447 Child MAP Child 2 $248 Child MAP Child 3 $245 Child MAP Child 4 $249 Child MAP Child 5 $200 Child MAP
7 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of five children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $277 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $477 Child MAP Child 2 $278 Child MAP Child 3 $276 Child MAP	Child 1 $248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $448 Child MAP Child 2 $247 Child MAP Child 3 $248 Child MAP

Child Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) Chart Effective October 1, 2026

Multiple Children Participating in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option

Multi-child opt-in to Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option is not available for an Assistance Unit (AU) size of two. At least one CalWORKs aided child must be in the AU

Assistance Unit Size	Region 1 Exempt	Region 1 Non-Exempt
	Child 4 $269 Child MAP Child 5 $280 Child MAP Child 6 $234 Child MAP	Child 4 $245 Child MAP Child 5 $249 Child MAP Child 6 $200 Child MAP
8 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of six children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $279 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $479 Child MAP Child 2 $277 Child MAP Child 3 $278 Child MAP Child 4 $276 Child MAP Child 5 $269 Child MAP Child 6 $280 Child MAP Child 7 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $248 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $448 Child MAP Child 2 $248 Child MAP Child 3 $247 Child MAP Child 4 $248 Child MAP Child 5 $245 Child MAP Child 6 $249 Child MAP Child 7 $200 Child MAP
9 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of seven children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $275 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $475 Child MAP Child 2 $279 Child MAP Child 3 $277 Child MAP Child 4 $278 Child MAP Child 5 $276 Child MAP Child 6 $269 Child MAP Child 7 $280 Child MAP Child 8 $234 Child MAP	Child 1 $246 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $446 Child MAP Child 2 $248 Child MAP Child 3 $248 Child MAP Child 4 $247 Child MAP Child 5 $248 Child MAP Child 6 $245 Child MAP Child 7 $249 Child MAP Child 8 $200 Child MAP

Child Maximum Aid Payment (MAP) Chart Effective October 1, 2026

Multiple Children Participating in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option

Multi-child opt-in to Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option is not available for an Assistance Unit (AU) size of two. At least one CalWORKs aided child must be in the AU

10 If adult(s) are aided only a maximum of eight children can opt into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option. There must be at least one eligible CalWORKs aided child in the AU.	Child 1 $281 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $481 Child MAP	Child 1 $250 Base Child MAP +200 CS Disregard $450 Child MAP
	Child 2 $275 Child MAP	Child 2 $246 Child MAP
	Child 3 $279 Child MAP	Child 3 $248 Child MAP
	Child 4 $277 Child MAP	Child 4 $248 Child MAP
	Child 5 $278 Child MAP	Child 5 $247 Child MAP
	Child 6 $276 Child MAP	Child 6 $248 Child MAP
	Child 7 $269 Child MAP	Child 7 $245 Child MAP
	Child 8 $280 Child MAP	Child 8 $249 Child MAP
	Child 9 $234 Child MAP	Child 9 $200 Child MAP

Counties shall use the figures noted as “Child MAP” to determine if the amount of child support is greater than the amount the child would receive for CalWORKs when the parent/caretaker relative has requested to have more than one child participate in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option (Please note for simplicity the California Department of Social Services made the decision that income would not be a factor and a straight MAP would be used).

If the amount of child support received is greater than the “Child MAP” for the child’s AU size with the child included, region and AU type, the child may participate in Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option if all other conditions are met.

Counties and the parent/caretaker relative may use the child support received by each child to determine who to assign as child 1, child 2 etc., when the children are opting into Child Support in Lieu of CalWORKs Grant Option at the same time based on the amount of child support it takes to meet the eligibility threshold for the child in the AU size/type/region and assignment of child order (child 1, child 2 etc.).